

Input Content (IC)

Score: 1/5 — Serious concern | Confidence: high

Benchmark: ASAP++ | Context: Qatari and Arab High School Arabic Essay Writers (Grades 10–12)

Input Content definition: Whether individual datapoint content is culturally and contextually appropriate for the target region.

Each section below is followed by an evidence table. Three types of evidence are cited: [QN] — verbatim quotes extracted from the benchmark paper; [WEB-N] — web sources consulted during assessment; [DN] / [DATASET-DN] — sampled datapoints from the benchmark dataset, with an interpretation note.

Justification

The benchmark's input instances are ~13,000 essays written entirely by native English-speaking US students in Grades 7–10 [Q3, Q10] across 8 prompts. The deployment targets Arabic-language Grade 10–12 students under the Qatar MOEHE curriculum (and other Arab curricula), writing to prompts grounded in Arab cultural, literary, and Islamic frames of reference [WEB-10, WEB-11]. There is no overlap in language, age band, nationality, curriculum, or cultural frame of reference. The anonymization scheme (e.g., @ORGANIZATION1, @PERSON1) was itself a source of interpretive difficulty even for the English annotators [Q41], and would compound transfer issues. No Arabic-language instances exist in the dataset.

ID	Evidence
Q3	"The ASAP AEG dataset comprises of approximately 13,000 essays, written across 8 prompts. The essays were written by students of class 7 to 10. Each essay was evaluated by 2 evaluators. 6 out of the 8 prompts only have overall scores. Only 2 of them have scores for individual essay attributes, like content, organization, style, etc." (p.1)
Q10	"All the essays were written by native English speaking children from classes 7 to 10." (p.2)
Q41	"One of the major problems that the annotators faced was the fact that all the essays were anonymized. Named entities, like The New York Times would be referred to as @ORGANIZATION1, Donald Trump would be referred to as @PERSON1, etc." (p.4)
WEB-10	Qatar MOE Arabic Language curriculum framework anchors Grades 1–12 writing standards (http://www.sec.gov.qa/En/Education/Pages/GradeAndSubject.aspx)
WEB-11	IMPACT-se review of Qatar 2025–2026 curriculum confirms Arabic Literature and politically/religiously contextualized content (https://www.impact-se.org/wp-content/uploads/Qatar-Report-2026-final.pdf)

Strengths

- The dataset is openly available for non-commercial research use under CC-BY-SA [Q51, Q52], so it could in principle serve as a methodological reference (not a content reference) for designing an Arabic counterpart.

ID	Evidence
Q51	"The resource is available online at https://cfilt.iitb.ac.in/~egdata/ ." (p.5)
Q52	"The resource is available for non-commercial research use under the Creative Commons Attribution-ShareAlike License." (p.5)

Checklist

Checklist item definitions:

ID	Assessment Question
IC-1	Do inputs require region-specific cultural/geographic/dialectal knowledge?
IC-2	Does culturally sensitive content align with target culture?
IC-3	Flag inputs assuming Western-specific knowledge
IC-4	Regional annotator recruitment for culturally sensitive instances
IC-5	Document content issues harming content validity

Checklist responses:

IC-1: Yes — Arab high school essay tasks require knowledge of Arabic literary tradition, Islamic ethical framing, classical rhetorical conventions (أصناف / دغالب), and country-specific civic content [WEB-11, cultural_norms_notes]. None of this is present in the benchmark inputs [Q10].

IC-2: No — the benchmark inputs are US student essays on US-curriculum prompts [Q3, Q10]; there is no alignment with Qatari/Arab cultural framing, Islamic values, or Arabic rhetorical norms.

IC-3: Yes — all benchmark inputs require Western-specific knowledge (US topics, English-language conventions, US-anonymized named entities like '@PERSON1' standing for figures such as Donald Trump [Q41]) that does not transfer to Arab student writers.

IC-4: INSUFFICIENT DOCUMENTATION — the benchmark documentation does not address recruiting regional annotators for re-validation; this would be a recommended remediation step.

IC-5: Content issues are categorical: zero Arabic-language data, zero Arab student writers, zero culturally-anchored prompts. This is a complete content validity violation for the deployment.

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WEB-3	QAES annotated Qatari argumentative writing with trait-specific conventions appropriate to Qatari context (https://www.mdpi.com/2306-5729/10/9/148)
WEB-11	IMPACT-se review of Qatar 2025–2026 curriculum confirms Arabic Literature and politically/religiously contextualized content (https://www.impact-se.org/wp-content/uploads/Qatar-Report-2026-final.pdf)
WEB-12	LAILA used annotators trained on Arab high school writing — example of appropriate annotator profile for this deployment (https://arxiv.org/abs/2512.24235)

Information Gaps

- The benchmark does not document any provision for non-English content, so it is structurally unable to support Arabic input.

Requires Expert Verification

- Specific Qatar/Arab essay prompt corpora that could substitute as content anchors (LAILA and QAES are candidates per [WEB-12, WEB-3]).

Remediation

Gap 1: Benchmark essays are English US Grade 7–10 student writing; deployment requires Arabic Grade 10–12 student writing under Arab curricula.

Recommendation: Replace ASAP++ entirely as a content reference. Use LAILA (7,859 essays) [WEB-12] as the primary corpus and QAES/QCAW [WEB-3] as the Qatari-anchored validation set; collect new student writing from Qatar MOEHE schools via the Qeducation LMS [WEB-15, WEB-17].

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WEB-12	LAILA used annotators trained on Arab high school writing — example of appropriate annotator profile for this deployment (https://arxiv.org/abs/2512.24235)

WEB-15	Qeducation LMS (CYPHER) supports Arabic-language interface — relevant target platform for natural-language Arabic feedback delivery (https://www.cypherlearning.com/blog/k-20/qatar-march-workshop-recap-empowering-students-teachers-and-parents-with-digital-technology-for-learning)
WEB-17	Official 'Qatar Education' mobile app provides RTL Arabic delivery channel (https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=app.qeducation.edu.gov.qa)